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Sara Zanzottera

I am a GenAI software engineer and experienced open-source maintainer with a focus on Python. I worked on projects ranging from voice agents to particle accelerators to LLM frameworks, data pipelines, IoT projects, and web apps. I love learning and diving deep into unfamiliar domains until I master them. I thrive in remote, unstructured, multicultural teams where quick iteration cycles and continuous delivery are key. I have a lot of experience handling the OSS community over several channels, but I love variety: other than coding I also enjoy writing documentation, tutorials, blog posts and giving talks.

Check out my GitHub profile (https://github.com/ZanSara/) and my blog (https://www.zansara.dev/).

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Lead AI Engineer

Kwal Inc. - *Apr. 2024 to today*

AI and LLM expert, working on voice agents for the recruitment sector. I implemented several iteration of our in-house voice agents and assisted the rest of the team with prompt design, automated testing of the agents, and offline conversation analysis.

NLP Engineer

deepset GmbH - *Sep. 2021 to Feb. 2024*

Core maintainer of the Haystack framework (https://github.com/deepset-ai/haystack/). Haystack is a mature open-source project which started out as a very advanced NLP framework for question answering and evolved into a complete LLM framework.
My tasks included implementing new features, writing plugins, handling community over GitHub and Discord, managing external PRs, writing documentation, tutorials, Colab notebooks, blog posts, and hosting office hours, webinars, meetup talks, conference talks.

Software Engineer

CERN - *Feb. 2018 to Aug. 2021*

Python expert of the group, mentoring several colleagues. I led the renovation of a Python data pipeline for the accelerator's instrumentation, closely iterated with the PyQt GUIs team to develop a RAD framework for physicists, and developed a Java application for particle accelerator technicians to manage low-level applications.

Full Stack Developer

CAI (Italian Alpine Club) - *2015 to 2021*

Several contracts, including:

- The ZanzoCam Project (https://zanzocam.github.io/en), an autonomous webcam based on Raspberry Pi. In operation since 2021 in ~100 huts on the Italian Alps.
- A web frontend for a canyoning trails GIS database (2019).
- A web application managing bookings for a mountain hut (2016).

EDUCATION

Double MSc in Data Science
EIT Digital, POLIMI & UNS
2016 - 2018

BSc in Computer Engineering
POLIMI & Tongji
2013 - 2016